

The Lean Startup — Mastery Quiz

Author: Eric Ries • 12 multiple-choice questions • Answer + explanation

Instructions: Choose the best answer before checking the answer and explanation.

1. *What is the core feedback loop?*

- A. Build → Measure → Learn
- B. Plan → Hire → Spend
- C. Design → Advertise → Exit
- D. Build → Scale → Ignore

Correct answer: A

Why: The loop turns product assumptions into experiments and learning.

2. *What is an MVP primarily for?*

- A. Winning awards
- B. Testing key assumptions with minimal effort
- C. Building every feature
- D. Avoiding customers

Correct answer: B

Why: An MVP is a learning mechanism for testing assumptions.

3. *What is validated learning?*

- A. Learning from real evidence that changes decisions
- B. Reading opinions only
- C. Measuring hours worked
- D. Building without customers

Correct answer: A

Why: Validated learning is evidence-based progress toward understanding the business model.

4. *What is a pivot?*

- A. A random change
- B. A strategic change based on evidence
- C. Giving up immediately
- D. Adding every requested feature

Correct answer: B

Why: A pivot changes direction while preserving the goal of learning and building a viable business.

5. What does *persevere* mean?

- A. Continue the current strategy because evidence supports it
- B. Never change
- C. Stop measuring
- D. Ignore customers

Correct answer: A

Why: Perseverance should be evidence-based, not stubbornness.

6. Why are *vanity metrics* dangerous?

- A. They are too precise
- B. They can look good without proving customer value
- C. They cannot be measured
- D. They always decline

Correct answer: B

Why: Metrics such as raw downloads can hide weak retention or engagement.

7. What is *innovation accounting*?

- A. Measuring whether experiments are producing meaningful progress
- B. Traditional bookkeeping only
- C. Avoiding metrics
- D. Counting meetings

Correct answer: A

Why: It connects experiments and metrics to decisions about the business model.

8. Why shorten *feedback loops*?

- A. To learn faster and reduce wasted work
- B. To increase bureaucracy
- C. To avoid experiments
- D. To slow releases

Correct answer: A

Why: Faster learning allows teams to stop ineffective work sooner.

9. What should an *experiment test*?

- A. The riskiest important assumption
- B. Every feature simultaneously
- C. Employee preferences only
- D. Competitor rumors

Correct answer: A

Why: Testing the highest-risk assumption provides the most valuable learning.

10. What is the danger of building too much before testing?

- A. Faster learning
- B. Wasted time and resources on an unproven idea
- C. Better evidence
- D. Stronger customer feedback

Correct answer: B

Why: Unvalidated development can produce a polished product nobody needs.

11. What should a startup optimize for?

- A. Maximum activity
- B. Maximum validated learning per unit of effort
- C. Maximum meetings
- D. Maximum features

Correct answer: B

Why: The lean approach prioritizes learning efficiency.

12. What is the core question behind the lean approach?

- A. Can we build everything?
- B. What is the fastest way to learn what customers actually value?
- C. How can we avoid users?
- D. How can we spend more?

Correct answer: B

Why: The method is fundamentally about reducing uncertainty through rapid experiments.

Scoring guide: 10–12 = strong mastery • 7–9 = good understanding • 4–6 = review the summary • 0–3
= reread the core concepts.